

L E S S O N 08

How Can God Be One... and Three?

3: The Trinity

Scripture Focus: *Deuteronomy 6:4 · Isaiah 45:5 · James 2:19*

The word Trinity does not appear in Scripture, yet the concept is clearly taught throughout the Bible. Christianity stands firmly on monotheism — there is only one true and living God, singular in essence. And yet, this one God eternally exists as three distinct Persons. The Trinity is not a problem to be solved but a mystery to be adored.

BY THE END

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to Deuteronomy 6:4 and Isaiah 45:5 and James 2:19.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

VOCABULARY

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Trinity	The one true God eternally existing as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit: one in essence, three in persons.

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Holy Spirit	The divine Person who indwells, teaches, convicts, empowers, and forms believers into the likeness of Christ.
Scripture	God's written Word, authoritative and sufficient for knowing Him, understanding salvation, and walking faithfully.
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.
Prayer	Personal communion with God in worship, dependence, confession, thanksgiving, and request.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see God Be One... and Three from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. The word Trinity does not appear in Scripture, yet the concept is clearly taught throughout the Bible. Christianity stands firmly on monotheism — there is only one true and living God, singular in essence. And yet, this one God eternally exists as three distinct Persons. The Trinity is not a problem to be solved but a mystery to be adored.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

Deuteronomy 6:4 and Isaiah 45:5 and James 2:19 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. Very important passage to look at when we look at the essence of who are of who Jesus Christ is John 1:es 1:3 and then verse 14.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. this doctrine is central to Christianity. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

Deuteronomy 6:4

Deuteronomy 6:4 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read Deuteronomy 6:4 first, then read Isaiah 45:5 and James 2:19. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

Very important passage to look at when we look at the essence of who are of who Jesus Christ is John 1:es 1:3 and then verse 14.

Study the passage:

- 1. What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
 - 2. What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*
 - 3. How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*
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FRAMEWORK

Biblical Trinity vs. Simplistic Error

BIBLICAL CONFESSION	COMMON ERROR
One God in essence.	Three separate gods.
Three distinct Persons.	One Person merely wearing different roles.
Father, Son, and Spirit work in perfect unity.	The Persons compete, disagree, or act independently.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does God Be One... and Three most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. We do not believe that in Christianity. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. So, in this study, we're going to do our best to teach what the Bible reveals about our God. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The

question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

God Be One... and Three belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. Our God is infinite and we have a very finite mind. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **God Be One... and Three should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **Scripture clearly identifies the Holy Spirit as God.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about god be one... and three?*

2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

3. *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about god be one... and three. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

1. Use Deuteronomy 6:4 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

2. Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

3. Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.
